Edexcel Specification: c1250–c1500

- **1. Causes of disease:** Supernatural/religious explanations, Astrology, Four Humours, and Miasma.
- **2. Prevention and treatment:** Religious actions, bloodletting, purging, purifying air.
- **3. Medical care:** The role of physicians, apothecaries, barber surgeons, and hospitals.
- **4. Case Study: The Black Death (1348):** Beliefs about its causes, treatments, and prevention.

MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

HOW HAS MEDICINE CHANGED FROM C1250 TO THE MODERN DAY?

Paper 1: Medicine Through Time with the Western Front - 18th & 19th C

Scholar: ____________________

Class: ____________________

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER TARGET GRADE: _________

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?			
L2: KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?			
L3: KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Explain the difference between Spontaneous Generation and Germ Theory.
- [ ] Analyze the significance of Robert Koch's scientific methodology in microbiology.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What did William Harvey discover about the human body?

What did Harvey prove wrong about Galen's theories of blood?

In what year did the Great Plague hit London?

What was 'Spontaneous Generation'?

Who published the Germ Theory in 1861?

What did Robert Koch contribute to Germ Theory?

Who wrote 'On the Fabric of the Human Body' (1543)?

What invention helped spread new medical ideas during the Renaissance?

Why did many doctors reject Germ Theory at first?

What method did Robert Koch use to isolate and photograph bacteria?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Germ Theory | Spontaneous Generation | Bacteriology

In nineteenth-century Britain, doctors struggled to agree on the causes of disease. Before Pasteur's breakthrough, the prevailing belief was [. . . . .] , which claimed that microbes were simply created by decaying matter. However, Pasteur's publication of [. . . . .] in 1861 proved that airborne microbes caused decay and illness. This laid the foundation for the new science of [. . . . .] , led by Robert Koch, who developed scientific methods to isolate and stain specific bacteria under powerful microscopes.

Q1. Identify the scientist who published the Germ Theory in 1861.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q2)

How did Pasteur's swan-neck flask experiment disprove the theory of spontaneous generation?

- [ ] A. It showed that liquids only decayed when exposed to airborne microbes, proving that microbes caused decay (not the other way around).
- [ ] B. It proved that microbes were killed by intense cold.
- [ ] C. It showed that diseases were spread by physical contact.
- [ ] D. It proved that microbes spontaneously appeared in a vacuum.

Q3. Describe what Spontaneous Generation was.

Q4. Explain how Robert Koch developed Pasteur's work.

Q5. Evaluate the significance of the Germ Theory on the history of medicine.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Which was more significant in transforming British medicine: Louis Pasteur's theoretical proof of Germ Theory in 1861, or Robert Koch's practical scientific methods to identify specific disease-causing microbes in the 1870s and 1880s?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (e.g., Pasteur disproving spontaneous generation and providing the core principles, vs. Koch growing bacteria on agar jelly, staining them with dyes, and finding the TB and cholera microbes).

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over the Pace of the Germ Theory Revolution

Historians actively debate how quickly Germ Theory transformed medical beliefs in Britain. While traditional narratives present Pasteur's 1861 publication as an overnight revolution that instantly swept away ancient superstitions, modern revisionist historians argue that the transition was incredibly slow and highly contested. They point out that Pasteur was a chemist, not a doctor, and his early work focused on wine and vinegar, leading prominent British medical authorities like Dr. Henry Bastian to reject his ideas for decades. It was only after Robert Koch identified specific human pathogens (such as the tuberculosis microbe in 1882) and developed practical laboratory techniques that the wider medical community gradually accepted the link between germs and disease.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. 'Louis Pasteur's publication of the Germ Theory was the biggest turning point in understanding the causes of disease.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. You may use the following in your answer:
- **spontaneous generation**
- **Robert Koch**

You must also use information of your own.

[16 marks • 20 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q8. Explain why Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory (1861) was a major turning point in medicine.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

Q9. Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of illness in the period c1700-c1900 were different from ideas about the cause of illness in the period c1500-c1700.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q10. 'Louis Pasteur's publication of the Germ Theory was the biggest turning point in understanding the causes of disease.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use the following in your answer:

- Spontaneous Generation
- Robert Koch

You must also use information of your own.

Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

General Notes

L2: KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Explain how hospital care and nursing standards were transformed c1700-c1900 under the influence of Florence Nightingale.
- [ ] Analyse how the breakthroughs of anaesthetics and antiseptics solved the critical surgical problems of pain and infection.
- [ ] Evaluate the role of government intervention in disease prevention through the 1875 Public Health Act.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was 'Spontaneous Generation'?

Who published the Germ Theory in 1861?

What did Robert Koch contribute to Germ Theory?

Who was Florence Nightingale?

What did Florence Nightingale believe caused disease?

Which anesthetic was discovered by James Simpson in 1847?

What did William Harvey discover about the human body?

Who was Thomas Sydenham?

Why did the 'Black Period of Surgery' occur after the discovery of anesthetics?

Who introduced antiseptic surgery using carbolic acid in 1865?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Laissez-faire | **Aseptic surgery** | **Compulsory**

Your Sentence:

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q1)

How did Florence Nightingale's 'Notes on Nursing' (1859) help to improve the survival rates of patients in British hospitals?

- ☐ A. It taught nurses how to perform complex internal surgery.
- ☐ B. It established strict protocols for hygiene, ventilation, and cleanliness, drastically reducing infection rates.
- ☐ C. It proved that germs caused disease and taught nurses how to use carbolic acid.
- ☐ D. It taught nurses how to discover new antibiotics.

Q2. Identify the first effective anaesthetic discovered in 1847.

Q3. Describe the state of surgery before 1847.

Q4. Explain how Joseph Lister solved the problem of infection.

Q5. To what extent did Simpson's discovery of Chloroform immediately improve surgery?

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Was the introduction of anaesthetics (James Simpson's Chloroform) or antiseptics (Joseph Lister's Carbolic Acid) a more significant turning point for patients undergoing surgery in the 19th century?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence (e.g., Chloroform solved patient pain but initially led to the 'Black Period' of higher death rates, while Carbolic Acid solved postoperative infection and dropped mortality rates from 46% to 15% but relied on Pasteur's Germ Theory).

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over the 'Black Period' of Surgery

Historians frequently debate the immediate consequences of James Simpson's 1847 discovery of chloroform. While popular history often celebrates chloroform as an overnight triumph that ended the horror of conscious amputations, medical historians point out that it ushered in a devastating 'Black Period' for British surgery. Because patients were unconscious and relaxed, surgeons attempted far deeper, more complex, and longer internal operations. However, because Lister's carbolic antiseptics were not introduced until 1865, surgeons still operated in filthy environments with unwashed hands and blood-stained coats. As a result, the 'Black Period' actually saw a dramatic increase in postoperative deaths from gangrene and infection, leading some historians to argue that the discovery of anaesthetics was a step backward for patient survival until antiseptics were finally developed.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. 'The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700-c1900.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

[20 marks • 25 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q8. Explain why Joseph Lister's development of carbolic acid was so significant in the history of surgery.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

Q9. Explain one way in which surgical treatments in the period c1700-c1900 were different from surgical treatments in the medieval period (c1250-c1500).

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q10. 'The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700-c1900.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

[20 marks • 25 mins]

You may use the following in your answer:

- Joseph Lister
- Chloroform

You must also use information of your own.

Pupil Voice

Which part of today's lesson did you find the most difficult or confusing, and what did you do to overcome it?

General Notes

L3: KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Explain the significance and limitations of Edward Jenner's development of the smallpox vaccine.
- [ ] Analyze how John Snow investigated the 1854 cholera epidemic and assess the significance of his findings.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who was Florence Nightingale?

What did Florence Nightingale believe caused disease?

Which anesthetic was discovered by James Simpson in 1847?

What disease did Edward Jenner vaccine against in 1796?

What did Edward Jenner observe that led to his vaccine?

Who discovered the cause of cholera in 1854?

In what year did the Black Death arrive in England?

What did Vesalius prove about Galen's anatomical ideas?

How did John Snow prove that cholera was spread by contaminated water?

What was the significance of the Public Health Act of 1875?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: ***Inoculation***

Q1. Identify the disease Edward Jenner created a vaccine for.

Q2. Describe how Jenner proved his vaccine worked.

Q3. Explain the actions John Snow took during the 1854 Cholera outbreak.

Q4. Evaluate the significance of the 1875 Public Health Act.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q5)

How did John Snow prove that cholera was a waterborne disease in 1854, long before the discovery of germs?

☐ A. By looking at the cholera bacteria under a microscope.

☐ B. By mapping the deaths around the Broad Street pump, proving the victims shared a water source rather than breathing the same 'bad air'.

☐ C. By boiling all the water in London and watching the disease disappear.

☐ D. By injecting a cholera vaccine into local residents.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Whose breakthrough was a more significant turning point in the history of disease prevention: Edward Jenner's 1796 discovery of smallpox vaccination, or John Snow's 1854 discovery that cholera was water-borne?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (e.g., Jenner's vaccine being the first scientific prevention method that eventually wiped out a disease globally, versus Snow proving the link between physical sanitation and disease, which directly paved the way for Bazalgette's sewers and the 1875 Public Health Act).

> **Your Notes:**
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Historian's Corner: The Debate over the Catalysts for Victorian Public Health Reform

Historians debate the extent to which John Snow's 1854 Broad Street investigation was the primary driver behind the cleanup of Victorian London. Traditional narratives portray Snow as a lone hero whose pump-handle intervention instantly convinced the government to abandon laissez-faire and build a new sewer system. However, revisionist historians argue that Snow's work had very little immediate impact because the medical establishment and the General Board of Health clung obstinately to miasma theory. They suggest that the real turning point was the combination of 'The Great Stink' of 1858, which physically disrupted Parliament, and the 1867 Reform Act, which gave working-class men the vote and forced politicians to promise sanitary reforms to win elections. This culminated in the compulsory 1875 Public Health Act once Pasteur's Germ Theory finally provided the scientific proof that Snow lacked.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850-c1900).

[12 marks • 15 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q8. Explain why there was rapid progress in public health during the second half of the 19th century.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

Q9. Explain one way in which the role of the government in preventing disease in the period c1700-c1900 was different from the period c1500-c1700.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Q10. Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850-c1900).

[12 marks • 15 mins]

You may use the following in your answer:

- John Snow
- The Great Stink

You must also use information of your own.

Pupil Voice

If you were teaching this lesson to Year 6, what is the ONE most important thing you would make sure they remembered?

General Notes

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 1: Medicine Through Time

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low) 2 3 4 5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

Factors Overview: 18th & 19th C

Edexcel focuses heavily on the factors that drove medical progress (or held it back). For each factor below, write one specific historical example from this period that either helped or hindered medical progress.

Factor	Specific Historical Example & Impact
Individuals	
The Church & Religion	
Government & Wealth	
Science & Technology	
Attitudes in Society	
War	